Checks that catch problems

Data engineering · Level 4 · Lesson 2



Today we will

- Write checks: range, gaps, repeats, allowed values.
- Write a check as a query that returns the bad rows.
- Decide what a failure does, and fix the source.

Remember

- No rows back means the check passes.
- Set bad rows aside; keep good data moving.
- Passing every check isn’t proof.

Planted mistakes

1. Warm-up (5 min): What could go wrong in a mark sheet?
2. Teach (8 min): Kinds of checks.
3. Write (10 min): Our class’s checks.
4. Test (12 min): Find the planted mistakes.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): What did no check catch?

Plant one mistake of each kind, plus one believable one (such as 12 typed as 15) that no rule can catch. Use made-up names.

Let’s discuss

1. Which check would have stopped the 999?
2. Why is “= NULL” a check that can never fail?
3. What should we say when every check passes?

Exit ticket

- Write one check as a rule and as a SQL query, and what should happen when it fails.